is an illusion. I always felt the truth in that. But how reassuring it was, after nibbling a mushroom, or ingesting ayahuasca, to experience it for myself.

The one remedy that proved most effective, however, was work. Helping others, doing some good in the world, looking outward rather than in. That was the path. Africa and Invictus, these had long been the causes closest to my heart. But now I wanted to dive in deeper. Over the last year or so I'd spoken to helicopter pilots, veterinary surgeons, rangers, and they all told me that a war was on, a war to save the planet. War, you say?

Sign me up.

One small problem: Willy. Africa was *his* thing, he said. And he had the right to say this, or felt he did, because he was the Heir. It was ever in his power to veto *my* thing, and he had every intention of exercising, even flexing, that veto power.

We'd had some real rows about it, I told Teej and Mike. One day, we almost came to blows in front of our childhood mates, the sons of Emilie and Hugh. One of the sons asked: *Why can't you both work on Africa?*

Willy had a fit, flew at this son for daring to make such a suggestion. *Because rhinos, elephants, that's mine!*

It was all so obvious. He cared less about finding his purpose or passion than about winning his lifelong competition with me.

Over several more heated discussions, it emerged that Willy, when I'd gone to the North Pole, had sadly been resentful. He'd felt slighted that *he* hadn't been the one invited. At the same time he also said that he'd stepped aside, gallantly, that he'd permitted me to go, indeed that he'd permitted all my work with wounded soldiers. *I let you have veterans, why can't you let me have African elephants and rhinos?*

I complained to Teej and Mike that I'd finally seen my path, that I'd finally hit upon the thing that could fill the hole in my heart left by soldiering, in fact a thing even more sustainable—and Willy was standing in my way.

They were aghast. Keep fighting, they said. *There's room for both of you in Africa. There's need for you both.*